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KEITH THE DRONE GUY LLC
EQUIPMENT SANITIZATION BEFORE MAINTENANCE POLICY

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Owner: Keith Merritt, Owner/IT Lead
Approved By: Keith Merritt, Owner

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1. PURPOSE

This policy ensures that equipment sent off-site for maintenance or repair is sanitized of CUI and sensitive data before departure.

2. SANITIZATION REQUIREMENTS

2.1 Before Off-Site Maintenance

Before any device is sent off-site (to a repair facility, vendor, or shipping for manufacturer warranty repair):

- a) All CUI and sensitive data must be removed or sanitized
- b) Keith Merritt reviews the device to confirm CUI removal
- c) Sanitization must use NIST SP 800-88 approved methods:
 - For SSDs/Flash storage: Cryptographic Erase (preferred)
 - For HDDs: DoD 3-pass overwrite (DBAN or equivalent)
 - If sanitization is not possible: device stays on-site and vendor performs maintenance on-site under escort

2.2 On-Site Maintenance (Preferred)

Whenever possible, maintenance is performed on-site to avoid the need for off-site data sanitization.

3. DOCUMENTATION

All equipment sent off-site is logged in the Equipment Sanitization Log (SharePoint: IT/MA-Sanitization-Log.xlsx) including: device, sanitization method, date, and who performed the sanitization.

4. DATA RECOVERY RISK

If a device cannot be sanitized before off-site service (e.g., failed drive that cannot be erased), the device is physically escorted by Keith Merritt or the data storage component is removed and retained before shipping.

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Approved: Keith Merritt 03/10/2026

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